Improving awareness and discoverability of replication studies

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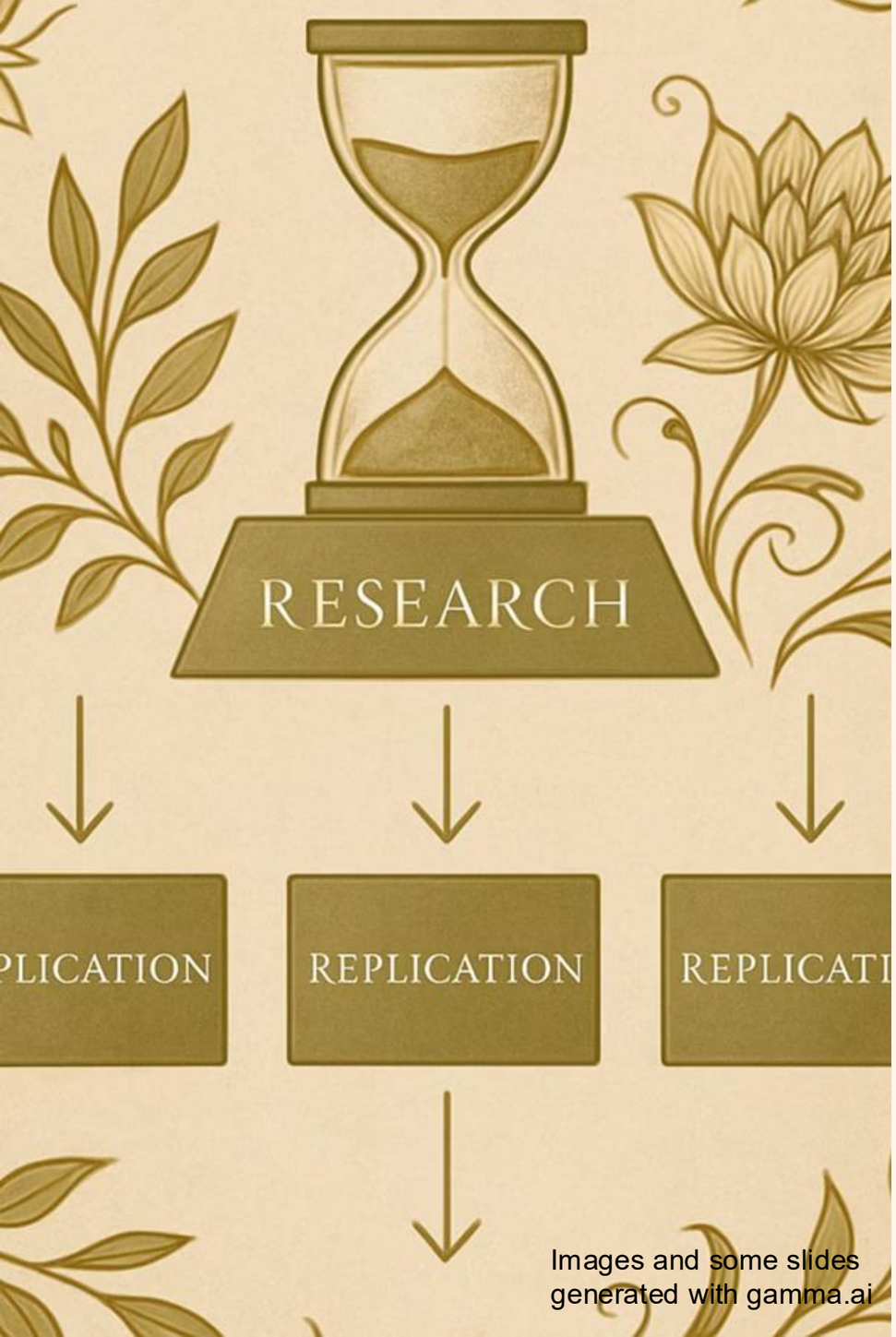

Images and some slides generated with gamma.ai

Replication = Science's *Self-Correction*

The Problem:
Valuable Replications Are Going Unnoticed

Scientific progress depends on knowing which findings are robust. Yet replications fail to have meaningful impact.

Low Visibility

Replications are rarely cited alongside original studies, unclear whether they are difficult to discover or undervalued.

Minimal Impact

Failed replications reduce citations of original work at most by 7-14% (though results largely based on large-scale projects, which may be special)

→ Unstable Foundations

Researchers continue building on unreliable findings, causing significant research waste and slowing scientific progress.

Barriers to Replication Visibility

Publication Bias

Top journals favour novel positive results over confirmations or null findings.

Lack of Specific Indexing

Databases don't tag replications; no option to link from originals.

Citation Practices

Researchers often don't cite replications; prefer simple story from unsystematic review

FLoRA A One-Stop Replication and Reproduction Repository

Built by **192 contributors** (and counting)

What is FLoRA?

FORRT Library of Replication and Reproduction Attempts

Partly based on the previous FORRT Database of Replications (FReD)

Originally crowdsourced, then expanded and validated in collaboration with COS

- Currently further expanded with AI-assistance

Key Use Cases

- CC-BY data for meta-research
- Annotator tool for reference checking
- Provides backend for further tools via API

https://forrt.org/flora-replication-atlas/

Pushing Relevant Replications

Preprint bot

Notifying authors of potentially relevant replication studies at the preprint stage

Zotero Plugin

Notifying users of missing replication studies in their libraries

PubPeer integration

For automated comments highlighting replication attempts

Metacheck module

Flags replications during self- and peer review

FLoRA annotator

Annotates list of references with replication findings.

Chromium Plugin

Shows banners for articles with replication attempts and augments Google Scholar results

What would you find helpful to identify relevant replications?

Thank you!

Framework for Open and Reproducible Research Training

FORRT

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